

Former GTRI Leader Jill Gostin Helps Engineers Navigate the AI 'Era'

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Jill Gostin

After concluding a distinguished career at the Georgia Tech Research Institute (GTRI), Jill Gostin continues to be a leader in the engineering profession.

Gostin, the 2026 IEEE President-Elect, retired from GTRI early last year after nearly four decades of service. She recently returned to familiar ground as a featured speaker during the IEEE "AI Tools for Career Growth" workshop hosted at GTRI Headquarters.

The event brought together students, early-career professionals, and experienced engineers to explore how artificial intelligence is changing the workplace and how technical professionals can use emerging AI tools to strengthen, rather than replace, their expertise.

For Gostin, the topic reflects a career spent helping engineers adapt to rapidly evolving technology.

During her years at GTRI, Gostin built a reputation as both an accomplished systems engineer and a collaborative leader. She served in numerous technical and management roles across the institute, including Deputy Director of the Information and Communications Laboratory, where she helped guide research programs while mentoring generations of engineers and researchers. Her work consistently emphasized not only technical excellence but also professional growth and lifelong learning.





A group picture during the IEEE AI Tools for Career Growth event. (Photo: courtesy IEEE)

Rather than portraying artificial intelligence as a disruptive force to fear, the event encouraged attendees to view AI as another tool in an engineer's toolkit. Participants explored practical applications, exchanged ideas with peers, and discussed how engineers can continue developing the uniquely human skills that remain essential in research, innovation, and leadership. The workshop also featured hands-on demonstrations, networking opportunities, and a pitch competition designed to help attendees apply what they learned.

The event also underscored GTRI's longstanding commitment to serving as a hub for technical collaboration beyond its own research programs. By hosting organizations such as IEEE, GTRI provides opportunities for engineers from industry, academia, and government to exchange ideas and build the skills needed to address emerging challenges.

Gostin was very prominent during the event. Throughout the day, she:

- Opened the event with the President-Elect Address.
- Served as a judge during the AI Innovation Pitch Competition.
- Participated in the closing Executive Leadership Panel.
- Engaged with attendees throughout the event.

Her keynote focused on preparing engineers for an AI-powered future through continuous learning, mentorship, resilience, and lifelong professional development.

Gostin's continued leadership within IEEE further reflects the impact of GTRI researchers well beyond the institute. Following decades of volunteer service, she now serves as the 2026 IEEE President, leading one of the world's largest professional organizations dedicated to advancing technology for humanity.

Although her GTRI career has concluded, Gostin's influence continues through the engineers she mentored, the professional organizations she has helped lead, and the conversations she continues to spark about the future of engineering.

As artificial intelligence reshapes the profession, her message remains consistent: technology will continue to evolve, but curiosity, continuous learning, and strong engineering fundamentals will remain the foundation of long-term success.

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